



THE CONSTITUTION OF TALK IT INITIATIVE

Youth Empowerment • Civic Participation • Community Transformation

"Your Voice, Our Future"

2025 EDITION

Adopted on the 10th day of October, 2025
Republic of Zambia

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PREAMBLE

We, the youth of Zambia, recognising that young people form the greater part of the population of this nation and therefore carry the greater part of its future;

Aware that lasting transformation begins with the ability to speak, to be heard and to act, and that many young people remain on the margins of the very conversations that shape their lives, their communities and their country;

Convinced that dialogue, civic education, innovation and volunteerism are among the most effective instruments through which young people may influence public policy, strengthen their communities and contribute to national development;

Acknowledging the need for a unified youth voice that drives social, economic and political transformation through dialogue and civic participation, and the need for an organised platform through which young people may turn ideas into action;

We, the members of Talk It Initiative, do hereby establish this Constitution to govern and guide the Organization's activities, leadership and membership, and bind ourselves to the values of integrity, inclusiveness, empowerment, innovation and accountability, for the betterment of our communities and of our nation.

We hereby adopt this Constitution as the supreme governing document of the Organization.

ARTICLE 1: NAME

The name of the organization shall be Talk It Initiative, herein referred to as “the Organization”.

ARTICLE 2: LEGAL STATUS AND AFFILIATION

1. The Organization shall be a non-profit-making, non-partisan youth organization established and operating in accordance with the laws of the Republic of Zambia.
2. The Organization shall exist as a body separate from its individual members, and no member shall have a personal claim to its funds, property or assets.
3. The Organization may affiliate to, partner with or collaborate with any association, institution, network, company or body whose objectives are consistent with this Constitution and whose affiliation is in the interest of the members, subject to the approval of the Board.
4. The Organization shall not be used to advance the interests of any political party and shall not engage in partisan political activity.
5. The Organization shall not discriminate against any person on the grounds of gender, tribe, religion, disability, political opinion or social status.

ARTICLE 3: HEADQUARTERS AND OFFICIAL ADDRESS

1. The headquarters of the Organization shall be in the Republic of Zambia, at such place as the Board shall determine from time to time.
2. The Organization shall maintain an official postal or physical address, and all official correspondence shall be addressed to the Secretary.
3. The Organization shall maintain an official email address and official social media accounts, which shall be held in the name of the Organization and remain in the custody of the Secretary and the Information, Communication and Technology Officer.
4. No member shall conduct official business of the Organization through a personal account or address without the written authority of the Board.

ARTICLE 4: IDENTITY AND GUIDING PRINCIPLES

Motto

“Your Voice, Our Future”

Mission

To empower young Zambians to speak out on relevant issues, promote civic education, influence public policy and contribute positively to nation-building.

Vision

To become Zambia's leading youth-driven organization for civic engagement, development dialogue and innovative storytelling.

Core Values

1. Integrity
2. Inclusiveness
3. Empowerment
4. Innovation
5. Accountability

Objectives

1. Provide a platform for youth dialogue and expression.
2. Promote civic education, responsibility and engagement.
3. Highlight key social and economic issues affecting the youth and the country at large.
4. Produce, share and distribute high-quality, educational content.
5. Create partnerships with other organizations, institutions, companies and individuals to promote the country's development.
6. Inspire leadership, innovation and volunteerism among young people.
7. Advocate for inclusive and participatory decision-making at all levels.

ARTICLE 5: MEMBERSHIP

Eligibility

Membership is open to all Zambians aged 16 to 35 who support the mission, vision and values of the Organization.

Advisory roles may be available to individuals over 35 years of age with relevant experience or significant contributions.

Categories of Membership

Founding Members: those who established the Organization.

General Members: active participants and contributors.

Honorary Members: individuals recognized for exceptional support.

Membership Fee

Membership of Talk It Initiative is open to all individuals who support the aims and objectives of the Organization, upon payment of a fee.

There shall be two categories of membership:

1. **Ordinary Members**

Open to all interested youth and stakeholders.

2. **Board Members**

These are individuals who hold leadership positions.

Rights and Responsibilities

Rights

1. Attend and vote in meetings.
2. Contest for leadership positions.
3. Access the events and opportunities of the Organization.
4. Access all resources and opportunities of the Organization, provided that such access aligns with this Constitution and internal policies.

Responsibilities

1. Uphold this Constitution and the values of the Organization.
2. Attend meetings and contribute to activities.
3. Avoid any conduct that brings the Organization into disrepute.

Membership Benefits

1. A platform to express views on national and community issues.
2. Exposure to real-world civic engagement experiences.
3. Connection with like-minded young people, professionals and organizations.
4. Opportunities to collaborate on projects and campaigns with national impact.
5. The chance to contribute articles and participate in panel discussions.
6. Enhanced skills in teamwork, critical thinking and digital literacy.
7. The opportunity to drive change and impact communities through organized projects.
8. Recognition for outstanding contribution and leadership.

ARTICLE 6: SUBSCRIPTIONS

- a) Membership fees shall be payable upon enrolment, and the amount payable for each category of membership shall be determined by the Board and communicated to the members.
- b) Subscriptions shall be renewed annually, or at such intervals as the Board may determine.
- c) A member whose subscription is in arrears for more than three (3) months shall not be entitled to vote, to contest for a leadership position or to hold office, until the arrears have been settled.
- d) All fees, subscriptions and contributions shall be paid into the bank account of the Organization and shall be receipted and recorded by the Treasurer.
- e) The Secretary shall maintain a register of members, and the Treasurer shall maintain a record of all subscriptions received.
- f) Membership fees, subscriptions and contributions are not refundable upon resignation, suspension or expulsion.

ARTICLE 7: LEADERSHIP STRUCTURE

The Board

The Board shall consist of seven (7) individuals, being three (3) Directors of the Organization and four (4) Board Members. The Board shall serve as the advisory and oversight body of the Organization, preserving the founding vision and values.

Board Structure

To ensure effective leadership and decision-making, the Board shall be made up of the following seven (7) key positions:

1. **President**
Leads the Board, oversees meetings and represents the Organization at official functions.
2. **Vice President**
Supports the President and steps in when the President is unavailable.
3. **Secretary**
Responsible for records, minutes of meetings and official communication.
4. **Treasurer**
Manages finances, prepares financial reports, oversees the budget and leads fundraising efforts.
5. **Programs Coordinator**
Oversees the planning and implementation of all Talk It Initiative programs and activities, tracks the impact of programs and ensures accountability.

6. Information, Communication and Technology Officer

Handles communication, branding and social media strategy.

7. Research and Advocacy Officer

Leads in research, policy development and advocacy campaigns, and engages with stakeholders and donors.

Duties and Responsibilities

The Board shall:

1. Preserve and uphold the founding vision, mission and values of the Organization.
2. Provide strategic guidance and long-term direction to the Executive Committee.
3. Serve as a neutral advisory body on matters of conflict, governance or constitutional interpretation.
4. Support resource mobilization efforts, stakeholder engagement and partnerships.
5. Approve major amendments to this Constitution and key policy decisions.
6. Act as custodians of the Organization's legacy, culture and long-term goals.
7. Represent the Organization at official functions, external meetings and engagements, accompanied by Executive Committee members.
8. Serve in an oversight capacity, providing strategic governance, policy direction and fiduciary oversight.

Terms and Tenure

1. The positions of President, Vice President and Secretary are permanently reserved for the Directors of the Organization. This provision ensures that the vision, mission and core values of the Organization remain consistent and safeguarded. The Chairperson, the Secretary and the other Director shall serve as President, Secretary and Vice President respectively.
2. The four (4) Board Members shall hold office for a term of two (2) years, renewable subject to satisfactory performance and confirmation by the Board.
3. Members of the Board may voluntarily step down, or may be removed by unanimous agreement, on the grounds of misconduct, incapacity or breach of foundational values.
4. Each Member of the Board is expected to contribute an agreed monthly financial donation to support the Organization's operational costs. This giving expectation is a formal requirement.
5. No Member of the Board shall receive a salary or any personal benefit from the funds of the Organization, save for the reimbursement of expenses properly incurred on behalf of the Organization and approved in advance.

Provincial Representation

1. There shall be a Provincial Representative chosen from each province in which the Organization has members or carries out its activities.
2. A Provincial Representative shall be selected by the Board from among the paid-up members of good standing in the province concerned, on the recommendation of the members in that province.
3. A Provincial Representative shall hold office for a term of one (1) year, which may be renewed, and shall serve under the oversight of the Board.

A Provincial Representative shall:

- Lead and coordinate the members and activities of the Organization in the province.
- Plan and propose activities, programs and outreach for the province, in consultation with the Programs Coordinator.
- Manage and support the provincial team and encourage participation in the activities of the Organization.
- Serve as the link between the members in the province and the Board.
- Submit a written report on provincial activities to the Secretary at the end of every quarter.

A Provincial Representative shall not commit the Organization to any financial or contractual obligation without the prior approval of the Board.

Creation of Additional Positions

1. Where the operations of the Organization so require, the Board may create additional positions or coordinator roles to ensure the smooth and efficient running of the Organization.
2. Every position so created shall have written terms of reference approved by the Board and shall be reported to the members at the next General Meeting.
3. The creation of an additional position shall not alter the composition of the Board as provided in this Article, unless this Constitution is amended in accordance with Article 19.

ARTICLE 8: COMMITTEES

Establishment of Committees

The Board may establish committees to carry out the work of the Organization. Every committee shall be headed by a Member of the Board and shall report to the Board.

Committee Structure

1. Disciplinary Committee

Chaired by the Vice President and shall include the Secretary and two (2) members appointed by the Board who have no interest in the matter under consideration. It shall handle complaints of indiscipline and breaches of the Code of Conduct and recommend appropriate sanctions. In the absence of the vice president, the president shall chair the committee.

2. Finance and Audit Committee

Chaired by a Member of the Board other than the Treasurer. It shall review the financial records of the Organization, oversee the annual audit and report its findings to the Board and to the Annual General Meeting.

3. Programs Committee

Chaired by the Programs Coordinator. It shall plan, implement and evaluate the programs, projects and community outreach activities of the Organization.

4. Fundraising and Partnerships Committee

Chaired by the Treasurer. It shall lead fundraising activities, donor engagement and the mobilization of resources for the Organization.

5. Publicity and Communications Committee

Chaired by the Information, Communication and Technology Officer. It shall manage the branding, publicity, media and social media presence of the Organization.

General Provisions on Committees

1. Each committee shall consist of not more than four (4) members drawn from the general membership based on interest and merit, in addition to its chairperson.
2. Committee members shall serve for a term of one (1) year, which may be renewed.
3. Every committee shall keep a record of its meetings, including attendance and minutes, and shall submit a written report to the Secretary at the end of every quarter.
4. No committee shall commit the Organization to any financial or contractual obligation without the prior approval of the Board.

ARTICLE 9: ELECTIONS AND APPOINTMENTS

1. The positions of President, Vice President and Secretary are reserved for the Directors of the Organization as provided in Article 7 and shall not be subject to election.
2. The four (4) Board Members shall be elected at the Annual General Meeting or appointed by the Board where a vacancy arises between Annual General Meetings, subject to confirmation at the next General Meeting.
3. A candidate for a Board Member position shall be a paid-up member of good standing who has been a member of the Organization for a period of not less than twelve (12) months.
4. Nominations shall be submitted in writing to the Secretary not less than fourteen (14) days before the date of the meeting at which the election is to be held.
5. Elections shall be decided by a simple majority of the members present and entitled to vote and shall be conducted by secret ballot where a position is contested.
6. The Board shall appoint two (2) members of good standing, who are not candidates, to preside over and verify the election, and the results shall be announced at the meeting and recorded in the minutes.
7. Any dispute arising from an election shall be referred to the Board, whose decision shall be final.

ARTICLE 10: PATRON AND ADVISORS

1. The Organization may appoint a Patron and such Advisors as it considers necessary, being individuals of good standing whose experience and influence are of benefit to the Organization.
2. The Patron and Advisors shall be nominated by the Board and ratified at a General Meeting of the Organization.
3. The term of office of the Patron and of an Advisor shall be one (1) year, which may be renewed.
4. The Patron and Advisors shall serve in an advisory capacity only. They shall have no voting rights and shall exercise no executive authority in the Organization.
5. The Patron and Advisors may be invited to attend meetings and activities of the Organization at any level and may offer guidance and advice to the Board and to the members.
6. The Patron and Advisors shall serve voluntarily and shall not receive any remuneration from the Organization.

ARTICLE 11: MEETINGS

General Meetings

1. Shall be held quarterly.
2. All members shall be invited.
3. The agenda shall include an activity review, plans and discussion forums.

Annual General Meeting

1. An Annual General Meeting shall be held once a year, within three (3) months after the end of the financial year.
2. The business of the Annual General Meeting shall include the annual report of the Organization, the annual financial statements and audit report, the election of Board Members, and any amendment to this Constitution.

Board Meetings

The Board shall meet to provide strategic guidance, monitor the Organization's long-term direction and resolve any high-level concerns or conflicts.

Board Meetings shall:

1. Be held at least twice a year, or as needed based on urgency or a request from the members.
2. Be chaired by the President of the Board.
3. Require a quorum of at least four (4) out of the seven (7) Board Members or proceed by mutual agreement.
4. Address constitutional matters, structural reforms, strategic direction and issues escalated by the Executive Committee.
5. Be documented, with minutes shared with the Executive Committee for transparency.

Notice of Meetings

1. Notice of a General Meeting shall be given to all members not less than fourteen (14) days before the date of the meeting.
2. Notice of a Board Meeting shall be given not less than seven (7) days before the date of the meeting.
3. An emergency meeting may be summoned by the President, or at the written request of not less than four (4) Members of the Board, on not less than forty-eight (48) hours notice.
4. Notice shall state the date, time, venue and agenda of the meeting, and may be given in writing or through the official communication channels of the Organization.
5. Members may attend any meeting in person or by electronic means, and a member so attending shall be counted for the purposes of the quorum.

Quorum

1. General Meeting: 50% + 1 of registered members.
2. Board Meeting: four (4) out of the seven (7) Members of the Board.
3. Where a quorum is not formed within thirty (30) minutes of the appointed time, the meeting shall stand adjourned to a date not more than fourteen (14) days later.

Decisions and Records

1. Decisions shall be taken by a simple majority of the members present and entitled to vote, save where this Constitution requires a two-thirds majority.
2. In the event of an equality of votes, the person presiding at the meeting shall have a casting vote.
3. The Secretary shall keep minutes of all meetings, and the minutes shall be confirmed at the next meeting and signed by the person who presided.

ARTICLE 12: FINANCE

Sources of Funds

1. Donations.
2. Sponsorships.
3. Fundraising activities.
4. Sale of branded merchandise.
5. Membership subscriptions.
6. Board Members' monthly contributions.
7. Grants from partners, institutions and cooperating organizations.

Use of Funds

All funds generated by Talk It Initiative shall be used strictly for the advancement of the Organization's mission and objectives.

No part of the funds or property of the Organization shall be distributed to any member as profit or personal gain.

Banking and Signatories

1. All funds of the Organization shall be held in a bank account opened and maintained in the name of the Organization with a reputable bank in Zambia.
2. There shall be three (3) signatories to the bank account, being the Chairperson, the Secretary and the Treasurer, and any two (2) of them shall sign for every transaction.
3. No funds of the Organization shall at any time be held in the personal bank account or mobile money account of any member.
4. All money received shall be banked promptly and intact and shall be supported by an official receipt of the Organization.

Authorisation of Expenditure

1. All expenditure shall be requisitioned in writing and shall be approved by the Chairperson and the Treasurer before payment is made.
2. Expenditure exceeding a limit set by the Board from time to time shall require the prior approval of the Board.
3. Every payment shall be supported by an invoice, receipt or payment voucher, which the Treasurer shall retain.
4. A petty cash float may be maintained within a limit set by the Board and shall be reconciled at the end of every month.
5. Funds received for a specific project, activity or donor purpose shall be applied only to that purpose and accounted for separately.

Financial Accountability

1. The Treasurer shall provide quarterly financial reports.
2. The financial year shall end in October.
3. The Treasurer shall maintain proper books of account recording all income, expenditure, assets and liabilities of the Organization.
4. Annual financial statements shall be prepared at the end of every financial year and presented to the Board and to the Annual General Meeting.
5. The financial records of the Organization shall be open to inspection by any Member of the Board on reasonable notice.

Assets of the Organization

1. The Secretary shall maintain a register of all assets and property of the Organization, showing the date of acquisition, cost and location of each item.
2. All assets acquired with the funds of the Organization, or donated to it, shall remain the property of the Organization.

3. Any member in possession of property of the Organization shall return it on demand, and in any event upon resignation, removal or expiry of the term of office.

ARTICLE 13: CODE OF CONDUCT

All members and leaders shall:

1. Uphold the values of integrity, respect and inclusion.
2. Avoid discrimination, hate speech and misinformation.
3. Promote unity and constructive dialogue.
4. Act in the best interest of the Organization and the public.
5. Protect the dignity and safety of every person the Organization works with, and of members and beneficiaries below the age of eighteen (18).
6. Declare, and refrain from participating in a decision on, any matter in which the member has a personal or financial interest.

Violations may result in suspension or expulsion following a disciplinary review.

Rules and Penalties

In the interest of the Organization and of the public, the following rules and penalties have been adopted. The Disciplinary Committee shall apply these rules to all members, committee members and Members of the Board without exception.

SN	AREA	RULE	PENALTY
1	Attendance and Participation	Attend all scheduled meetings and participate actively.	• First unexcused absence: written warning. • Second: suspension for one quarter. • Repeated absence: removal from position.
2	Adherence to Duties	Fulfil assigned roles and responsibilities.	• Failure to meet duties: verbal warning. • Second failure: written warning. • Repeated failure: demotion or removal.
3	Confidentiality	Maintain the confidentiality of sensitive discussions and records.	• Breach: immediate suspension pending investigation. • Proven breach: removal and possible leadership ban.
4	Conduct and Reputation	Act professionally and uphold the reputation of the Organization.	• Minor offence: written apology and warning. • Major offence: suspension or expulsion.
5	Financial Accountability	Use funds properly and pay dues promptly.	• Mismanagement: suspension, reimbursement and, as a last resort, legal action.

SN	AREA	RULE	PENALTY
6	Conflict of Interest	Avoid and declare any interest that undermines integrity.	• First instance: formal reprimand. • Repeated: removal from position.
7	Respect for this Constitution	Follow this Constitution and the decisions of the Organization.	• Non-compliance: warning or suspension. • Persistent refusal: expulsion.
8	Care of Property	Use the property, equipment and platforms of the Organization responsibly.	• Violations: restricted access, restitution or suspension.
9	Respectful Behaviour	Treat all individuals with respect and dignity.	• Counselling or apology for minor issues. • Suspension or expulsion for severe cases.
10	Unauthorised Representation	Do not speak or act on behalf of the Organization without permission.	• Formal reprimand or suspension.
11	Safeguarding	Protect members and beneficiaries from harm, abuse and exploitation.	• Any breach: immediate suspension, investigation and referral to the relevant authority where required.
12	Serious Offences	Harassment, fraud, theft and gross misconduct.	• Immediate suspension. • Permanent removal. • Leadership ban.

ARTICLE 14: DISCIPLINE, SUSPENSION AND EXPULSION

1. A complaint against a member shall be made in writing to the Secretary, who shall refer it to the Disciplinary Committee within seven (7) days of receipt.
2. A member who is the subject of a complaint shall be given written notice of the allegations and not less than seven (7) days in which to respond and shall have the right to be heard and to be accompanied by another member.
3. The Disciplinary Committee may recommend a verbal warning, a written warning, suspension, removal from position, restitution of any loss caused, or expulsion.
4. The suspension or expulsion of a member shall require a two-thirds majority of the Board and shall be ratified at the next General Meeting by a two-thirds majority of the full members present.
5. A member who is dissatisfied with a decision of the Disciplinary Committee may appeal to the Board within fourteen (14) days, and the decision of the General Meeting shall be final.

6. A member who is expelled shall cease to enjoy all rights and benefits of membership, shall not be entitled to a refund of any fee or contribution, and shall return all property and records of the Organization within seven (7) days.
7. The Disciplinary Committee shall handle every matter fairly, confidentially and without favour, so that no member is treated as being above the rules of the Organization.

ARTICLE 15: RESIGNATION, VACANCIES AND REMOVAL FROM OFFICE

1. A Member of the Board or any organisation leader who wishes to resign shall give not less than fourteen (14) days written notice to the Board.
2. During the notice period, the resigning member shall give a full account of the duties carried out, hand over all records and property in their possession, and prepare a report on current and future responsibilities for the succeeding member.
3. A Member of the Board or any organisation leader may be removed from office for misconduct, incapacity, breach of the foundational values of the Organization, absence from three (3) consecutive meetings without apology, or conduct that brings the Organization into disrepute, following the process in Article 14.
4. Removal from office shall require a two-thirds majority of the Board or of the full members present at a General Meeting.
5. Where a vacancy arises, the Board may appoint one of its members to act, and the vacancy shall be filled within thirty (30) days in accordance with Article 9.
6. A vacancy in the office of President, Vice President or Secretary shall be filled only by a Director of the Organization, in accordance with Article 7.
7. Where two-thirds of the Board resign or are removed from office, the remaining members shall convene a General Meeting within twenty-one (21) days for the purpose of filling the vacancies.
8. No outgoing officer shall be granted clearance until all property, records and accounts of the Organization in their possession have been handed over.

ARTICLE 16: AUDIT AND MISAPPROPRIATION OF FUNDS

1. The books of account of the Organization shall be examined at least once a year, at the end of the financial year and before any handover of office.
2. The examination shall be carried out by the Finance and Audit Committee or by an independent person appointed by the Board, who shall not be a signatory to the bank account of the Organization.
3. The audit findings shall be presented to the Board and to the Annual General Meeting.
4. Where an office bearer, individually or together with others, is found to have misappropriated the funds of the Organization, that person shall refund the amount involved in full within a

period stipulated by the Board, and shall in addition be subject to disciplinary action under Article 14.

5. Where restitution is not made, the Organization shall, as a last resort, report the matter to the relevant authorities and may institute legal proceedings to recover the amount involved.
6. The financial and governance records of the Organization shall be retained for a period of not less than six (6) years.

ARTICLE 17: HANDOVER

1. At the end of a term of office, outgoing officers shall hand over to the incoming officers within fourteen (14) days.
2. The handover shall include the minute books and records of meetings, financial records and bank documents, the register of members, the register of assets, contracts and agreements, correspondence files, and the credentials of all official email and social media accounts.
3. The outgoing officer shall prepare a written handover report setting out completed work, work in progress and outstanding matters.
4. A handover certificate shall be signed by the outgoing and the incoming officer and witnessed by the Chairperson and the Secretary.
5. No officer shall retain any property, record or account of the Organization after handover.

ARTICLE 18: MONITORING, EVALUATION AND REPORTING

The Organization shall monitor and evaluate its activities and outcomes regularly. An annual impact report shall be prepared and presented to the Board and made available to stakeholders. This report shall track progress towards the Organization's mission, highlight key achievements and identify areas for improvement, to ensure transparency and continuous growth.

ARTICLE 19: AMENDMENTS

1. This Constitution may be amended by a two-thirds majority vote.
2. Proposals must be submitted in writing to the Secretary.
3. All members shall be notified fourteen (14) days prior to the amendment meeting.
4. No amendment shall be made which is inconsistent with the mission, vision or core values of the Organization.
5. Every amendment shall be recorded in the Amendment Record, and the amended Constitution shall be signed by the Chairperson and the Secretary.

ARTICLE 20: DISSOLUTION

Upon dissolution, the Board shall publicly invite bids from members of the public who are interested in purchasing the assets of the Organization.

Any funds remaining after the settlement of all liabilities of the Organization shall be applied to a purpose consistent with the objectives of the Organization, as resolved by a General Meeting.

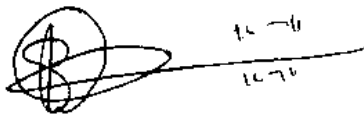
ARTICLE 21: ADOPTION AND SIGNATURES

This Constitution was prepared and officially adopted by the Directors of the Organization on this 10th day of October 2025.

Upon adoption, all offices created by this Constitution became effective.

By signing below, the Directors affirm their commitment to uphold the principles, vision and values of Talk It Initiative, and to guide its development in accordance with this Constitution.

Chairperson / Director
Sylvester Simutowe



Signature

Date: 10 October 2025

Secretary/Director
Tiza Kalulu



Signature

Date: 10 October 2025